Consignment Store App: Revised Proposal

Buckeye Game Fest · November 3, 2026

Summary

We propose a custom web app to manage the consignment store, from seller listings through check-in, checkout, inventory tracking, and payout reports. The app will be the authoritative system for consignment inventory and sales.

The app will contain only consignment store data. Square will handle payment processing. The consignment app will not process payments, collect payment information, or manage payment transactions.

The same app will be reused every year, with past event records preserved. Each event will have its own seller accounts, so sellers receive a new account each year.

- **Who uses it:** Board members (admins), volunteers, and sellers, all signed in. There will be no public page or direct self-registration in the app.
- **What it replaces:** Paper tracking, manual inventory management, and manual payout calculations.
- **Payment processing:** Square POS handles all payments, including cash and card. The consignment app records completed sales and supports reconciliation against Square.
- **Seller accounts:** Seller account information will be obtained through a Google Form. The app should connect directly to Google Forms to create accounts, with CSV import available as a backup.
- **What we're asking for:** Approval of the fee rules, operating flow, hosting budget, and remaining policy decisions.

User roles and access

The app has three user roles:

- **Sellers** see only their own games and sales report.
- **Volunteers** see every item in the current event, grouped by seller and searchable. They handle check-in, checkout, and pickup.
- **Admins** see everything, including past events and financial reports. They manage accounts, event settings, and administrative functions.

All users sign in. There will be no public page or direct self-registration in the app.

User accounts

- Admin accounts and permissions.
- Volunteer accounts and permissions.
- Seller accounts and permissions.
- Admin ability to create, edit, deactivate, and manage accounts.
- Automatic seller account creation from Google Form submissions.
- CSV import available as a backup or manual import method.
- Seller login and agreement to consignment rules.
- Password setup and security.

Admin Accounts

Initial Admin Account Creation

During initial app deployment, the developer will establish the first admin account directly through the app's secure backend. BGF will designate the individual who should receive this account. That individual will receive login credentials or complete a secure password setup to access the app.

Once the initial admin account is established, admin users can create additional admin accounts through the app's account management tools. The initial setup process will be disabled or locked down after the first admin account is created. Admin accounts do not expire.

Volunteer Accounts

Volunteer accounts can only be created by an Admin. Volunteer accounts do not expire.

Admins can grant existing volunteer accounts access to specific active events. A volunteer's account remains available between events, but event access must be assigned by an Admin for each event.

Volunteers can also register as sellers for individual events. They must complete the same seller registration process as other sellers, including submitting the seller registration form.

Volunteer accounts include a list of active and past events for which the volunteer has access.

For active events, display:

- A checkbox: **Seller for this event?**

- A field to enter their Seller ID for that event so the app can connect their volunteer and seller accounts and apply the appropriate fee overrides.
- The account connection and applicable fee overrides happen automatically. No additional Admin approval is required.
- Once they are connected, the volunteer will have access to the seller account for that event from the volunteer account page.
- Admins can view a list of volunteers who are also sellers for each event.

Seller account creation and imports

Seller accounts are created separately for each event. A seller who participates in multiple years receives a new account for each event. Accounts and seller information are not automatically carried forward from previous years. Each seller will be assigned a unique Seller ID.

Seller ID format should be: [Format to be determined]

The preferred process is a direct connection between the app and the designated Google Form:

- The app retrieves new form submissions and creates seller accounts for the current event automatically.
- The app tracks which form responses have already been imported so the same response is not processed twice.
- If a seller submits the form more than once for the same event, the duplicate submission is flagged for review rather than automatically creating another account.
- CSV import remains available as a backup.

New imports must not overwrite or change existing seller accounts for the event. Previously imported accounts remain unchanged.

The first time a seller logs in, display all the selling rules, including all fees, and specify that sellers agree to the terms to continue and also by listing items in the consignment store.

Event Setup

An administrator can create and configure each year's event.

Event settings include:

- Event name and dates.
- Number and names of price windows.

    - The number and names of price windows can be changed until items have been added for the event. Once any items have been added, the number and names of the windows are locked.
- Start and end date/time for each price window.
    - The scheduled start and end dates and times for price windows can be changed by an administrator.
- Listing Fee structure and amount as detailed below
- Commission rate, expressed as a whole percentage of the sale price.
- Unsold item fee.
- Whether unsold item fees apply to donated items.
- Fee exceptions and waivers as detailed below
- Link to the Google Form for seller signups.
- Event status depending on what stage of the process we are in: set up, presale, check-in, sale, pickup, or post-sale status for each event.

Listing Fee Structure

The Listing Fee must use one of two structures for the event:

- Master sheet fee: A fee based on the number of items, with partial sheets rounded up.
- Seller fee: A flat fee per seller.

The administrator selects which Listing Fee structure applies to the event. The two structures are alternatives, not cumulative fees.

Changing Fees and Settings

- Fees cannot be adjusted once a seller has signed up for the event.
- Event-specific settings and fees are preserved with that event. Changes made for a future event do not affect previous event records or reports.

Fees Example(current defaults, adjustable each year)

Fee	Amount	Based on
Commission	10%	Each item's actual sale price

Listing Fee: Master sheet	$2.00 per sheet	Items actually checked in, 20 per sheet, partial sheets count as full. Used only if this Listing Fee structure is selected.
Listing Fee: Seller	$0 flat rate	Per seller. Used only if this Listing Fee structure is selected.
Unsold item fee	$0.25 per item	Checked-in items not sold when the store closes, subject to the event's donated-item fee setting.

The event uses either the master sheet Listing Fee or the flat seller Listing Fee, not both.

Event fee options

Two additional event settings control how fees are applied:

- **Charge unsold item fees for donated items?** Yes / No.
    - Yes: Donated items are included in the unsold item fee calculation.
    - No: Donated items are excluded from the unsold item fee calculation.
- **Charge sellers for negative balances?** Yes / No.
    - Yes: If fees exceed sales, the app records the negative balance as an amount owed by the seller. The organization collects that amount outside the app. The app does not need to track collection.
    - No: If fees exceed sales, the seller's recorded payout is $0. No negative balance is carried forward or recorded as an amount owed.

Fee exceptions must be configurable for consignment volunteers, Administrators, and Individual Sellers. Administrators should be able to select which fees are waived for each category. Record which administrator waived fees. Financial Reconciliation should include a report about waived fees. Fee waivers do not constitute a change to the event's underlying fee structure.

Past event records must remain preserved and accessible to administrators.

Seller accounts and listings

Seller accounts will have an interface for adding items with the following information:

- Name
- Publisher
- Description
- Condition: dropdown selection with optional text box
    - New / Mint
    - Good
    - Fair / Incomplete. If this option is selected the text box cannot be left empty.
- Price boxes equal to the number of Price windows using the window names set up during event creation. Each item has one price for each configured window. Sellers enter their prices, which may increase or decrease between windows. Each price must be at least $1 and must be in whole dollars.
- Bundle checkbox with number of items.
- BGG ID (optional). Not printed on the sales slips.
- Check boxes: Large slip (larger boxes, prints 2/page) or Small slip (small game, prints 6/page).
- Check box: Donate Item if not sold.

Sellers may view, add, change, and deactivate items until they generate sales slips. Items can have missing information until sales slips are generated. At that point, the system should require all listings to be complete or deactivated before generating slips.

Once a sales slip is generated, sellers can view or deactivate those listings. They cannot edit an existing listing without first deactivating it. They can still add new items.

Deactivated items and reactivation

Deactivated listings are retained permanently. They are not physically removed from the database.

Sellers will have a separate **Deactivated Items** section where they can view their deactivated listings and choose to reactivate them.

- Sellers may edit a deactivated listing before reactivating it.
- If the listing is reactivated without any changes, its previously generated sales slip remains valid.
- If any information on the listing is changed, the previously generated sales slip becomes invalid.
- A reactivated listing with an invalidated sales slip will show that no valid sales slip is attached. The seller must generate a new sales slip before bringing the item to check-in.
- Reactivated listings return to the seller's active item list.
- Deactivated listings do not appear in normal active inventory or subsequent sales-slip generation unless they are reactivated.

Any change to a listing invalidates its existing sales slip, regardless of how small the change is.

The seller's active list of games should include a column specifying whether a valid sales slip was created for that game.

Subsequent creation of sales slips will only include active games without a valid sales slip.

Sellers should have the option to reprint any valid sales slips by a checkbox column next to the sales slips with a reprint button at the bottom.

Sales slips

Sales slips will be generated as a formatted PDF document with a slip for each item.

The slips will contain:

- Name
- Publisher
- Description
- Condition
- Prices for each configured price window
- Item ID
- Barcode (of item ID)
- Seller ID
- Event Name

If Bundle is checked, list the number of items in the bundle.

If Donate is checked, include [Format or image to be determined].

Sales slip format:

- Large slip: 2 per page.
- Small slip: 6 per page.

Barcode format should be: [Format to be determined]

Inventory setup and check-in

The app is the authoritative system for consignment inventory.

Every game must be entered into the app and have a valid sales slip generated before it can be accepted at check-in. No games can be added to the system at check-in.

- Every physical game has a unique barcode.
- Every game must already exist in the app and have a valid sales slip before arriving at check-in.
- At check-in, each game is scanned to confirm it is onsite and that the information and listed prices are correct.
- Sellers cannot withdraw items after check-in.
- After all of a seller's items have been processed, the volunteer selects **Confirm Check-in**.
    - The app displays a check-in report showing:
        - The number of items successfully checked in.
        - A list of items that were not checked in (status = Listed).
        - Any check-in errors and their outcomes.
    - The volunteer then chooses one of two options:
        - **Check-in Complete:** Finalizes the seller's check-in and generates the report, which is saved to the seller's account.
        - **Check in Additional Items:** Returns to the scanning screen to continue checking in items for the same seller.
- Items not checked in remain in Listed status.

Check-in errors

- **Barcode does not exist:** The game cannot be accepted. The error is included in the check-in report saved to the seller's account.
- **Listing is deactivated:** The game cannot be accepted unless the seller wishes to reactivate the item using the information as it exists on the sales slip. The check-in screen allows reactivation of the listing. The outcome, whether reactivated or rejected, is included in the check-in report saved to the seller's account.
- **Item already checked in:** The app displays an error. The volunteer must determine which of the following situations applies:
    - **Accidental double scan:** The volunteer selects **Double Scanned Item**. No changes are made to the item's status, and the volunteer can continue checking in other items.
    - **Two physical games have the same sales slip:** Both games must be set aside for Admin review. The Admin examines both games, removes the duplicate slip from one, and determines which physical game has the correct sales slip. The game with the correct sales slip can be accepted. The other game cannot be accepted under the same listing. An Admin override is required to continue. The Admin may authorize inclusion after investigating the situation, but must add a note. Only one physical game can be associated with the listing and included in a sale.
    - **Any other situation:** The volunteer cannot continue checking in until an Admin investigates and authorizes an override. If the item is allowed into the sale, its status becomes Available. If it is not allowed into the sale, its status becomes Error and it cannot be sold.

All double-scan errors, Admin overrides, and their resolutions are recorded in the check-in report saved to the seller's account. Admin overrides are also logged with the identity of the Admin who authorized them. An item is never included more than once. Admins must include a note when authorizing an override.

The method for Admins to activate overrides still needs to be determined.

Item statuses

Status	Meaning
Listed	Seller has entered the item, but it has not been checked in.
Deactivated	Seller removed the item from active listings. The record and its history are retained.
Available	Item has been checked in and is available for sale.
In checkout	Item is temporarily reserved in an active sale.
Sold	Payment has been received and recorded in the consignment app.
Missing	Item cannot be located when expected. Admin only can set this status.
Returned	Item has been returned to its seller.
Donated	Item was unsold and donated to the organization.

Error	Used for exceptional situations requiring an error status.

Item status changes are recorded with the person responsible and the time of the change.

An item with any status other than Available cannot be added to a new checkout.

Pickup and unsold inventory

- Sellers cannot withdraw items after check-in.
- Unsold items that sellers do not collect are donated to the organization.
- Whether an unsold item fee applies to donated items is determined by the event setting.
- Items marked for donation by the seller are identified in the seller listing.
- All active carts must be deactivated before pickup begins.
- Volunteers scan items at pickup when returning them to the seller.

Pickup errors

When a volunteer scans an item at pickup, the app checks its current status.

- **Available:** The item can be returned to the seller. Its status changes to Returned.
- **Listed:** The app generates an error, but the seller may take the item back. Its status changes to Returned.
- **In checkout:** Pickup cannot begin until all active carts have been deactivated, so this status should not occur during pickup.
- **Sold:** The item cannot be returned to the seller. An Admin must investigate and resolve the error. Sold status can never be overridden.
- **Deactivated:** The app generates an error, but the seller may take the item back. Its status changes to Returned.
- **Donated:** Donated items should be pulled before pickup begins. If the seller confirms the donation, the status remains Donated. If the seller changes their mind and wants the item back, its status changes to Returned.
- **Error:** Requires Admin intervention and resolution before the item can be returned to the seller.

All pickup errors and Admin overrides are recorded in the item's history, including the person responsible and the time of the action.

Price windows and checkout pricing during event

Admin control of the active price window

The administrator must be able to select which price window is currently open. The scheduled start and end times define the intended schedule, but the administrator's selection determines which window is active for checkout.

This allows the organizers to control the transition between pricing windows. For example, when one window closes, the waiting line can be cleared before the next window is activated.

- The app prominently displays the currently active price window on the checkout screen.
- Checkout uses the price associated with the active window.
- The app must not automatically advance to another window without the appropriate administrator action.
- The app records which window and price were used for each sale.
- Changes to the active window are recorded with the administrator's name and timestamp.
- Sales are blocked when no price window is active, unless an authorized administrator uses an override.

Starting a sale

- A volunteer must be logged in to perform checkouts.
- A volunteer can be logged into only one register at a time. Each register can have only one active sale at a time.
- Scanning an item adds it to the open sale and temporarily reserves it.
- Every game has a unique barcode.
- The app displays a running item count and cost total prominently at the top of the checkout screen.
- Each item is listed individually with its price and a **Remove** action.
- There is always a global **Cancel Sale** button at the top that allows the volunteer to abandon the entire transaction and start a new one.
    - A confirmation prompt appears before cancellation is confirmed.
- If an item is already in another active checkout, the app displays an error identifying the volunteer account holding the other active transaction. The volunteer sets the item aside.
- An administrator can investigate an item held in another active checkout and release it if necessary.
- If an item is scanned twice in the same transaction, the app displays an error stating that the item is already in the transaction. Do not add it twice.
- Any item with a status other than Available triggers an error.
- An item marked Sold triggers an error and the volunteer must set it aside, NOT return it to the sale tables.

Checkout scan errors

A rejected scan must not change the item's existing status or otherwise affect the transaction.

- The app reports the error to the volunteer.
- The item is not added to the transaction.
- The item's existing status remains unchanged.
- The transaction continues normally, and the volunteer can scan other items.

If an item is already reserved in another active checkout, the error identifies the account holding that checkout. An administrator can investigate and release the item if appropriate. Administrative release actions are logged.

Before payment

When scanning is finished and the volunteer selects **Proceed to Payment**, the app creates a Sale ID and displays a Sale Summary showing:

- Sale ID (created by the app).
- Total number of items included in the sale.
- Total amount due.
- Total number of restock items, clearly differentiated.
- Names of any restock items, with a prominent instruction: **MOVE THESE ITEMS TO THE RESTOCK TABLE NOW.**
- The available actions: **Cancel Sale** and **Payment Received**.

Sale ID and payment

The Sale ID is the internal identifier for the sale in the consignment app. It is not a Square transaction ID.

Once a Sale ID is created:

- The sale contents and total are locked.
- The volunteer has only two available actions:
    1. **Cancel Sale**
    2. **Payment Received**
- Individual items cannot be removed or changed after the Sale ID is created.
- All items associated with the sale, including items removed before the Sale ID was created, remain reserved until the sale is resolved.
- Canceling the sale releases all associated items and returns them to Available status.

The app does not process payments or collect payment information.

A sale is not considered complete, and its purchased items are not marked Sold, until the full payment has been successfully received and recorded in the consignment app by selecting **Payment Received**.

After payment

Once **Payment Received** is selected:

- The sale is marked complete and permanently locked.
- No edits, removals, reversals, or refunds are permitted.
- Items included in the completed sale are permanently marked Sold.
- Items removed before the Sale ID was created become Available.
- The volunteer can begin another sale once the current sale is resolved.

Item availability during an active transaction

All items successfully added to a transaction, including items later removed from the purchase, remain reserved until the entire transaction is resolved.

- **Cancel Sale:** All items associated with the transaction become Available again.
- **Payment Received:** Items included in the purchase become Sold. Items removed from the purchase become Available again.

Items rejected by a scan error are not part of the transaction. Their existing statuses are not changed.

Reports and Event Closing

Seller payout calculations

A seller's net payout is calculated by subtracting the applicable fees from sales. The app calculates every figure to the cent, rounded half up. Fee amounts and settings are set per event, so changing them in a future year does not change previous reports.

Items that never arrive cost the seller nothing. No items can be added at check-in.

Net payout

Net payout is calculated as:

Net payout = Sales − Commission − Listing Fee − Unsold Item Fees

The app calculates the Listing Fee using the fee structure selected for the event. It calculates unsold item fees according to the event's donated-item setting.

If the event setting **Charge sellers for negative balances?** is No, the app must not show a negative seller payout or an amount owed by the seller. If fees exceed sales, the seller's recorded payout is $0.

If the setting is Yes, the app records the negative balance as an amount owed by the seller. Collection happens outside the app and a transaction number and note about how the fee was collected should be noted by the Admin.

Two worked examples

These examples use the master sheet Listing Fee structure and the default fee settings.

	Seller A	**Seller B**
Items checked in	23	5
Items sold	15	0
Sales	$120.00	$0.00
Commission (10%)	-$12.00	$0.00
Listing Fee	-$4.00 (2 sheets)	-$2.00 (1 sheet)
Unsold fees	-$2.00 (8 items)	-$1.25 (5 items)

Net payout	**$102.00**	**$0.00**

Accuracy rules

- All money is stored in whole cents, so there are no floating-point rounding surprises.
- Commission is rounded half up per item.
- Each sale records the price window and price actually charged. Reports use those recorded figures and never recalculate historical sales.
- Fee calculations use the settings established for that event.
- Final seller balances are calculated using the event's selected fee settings and any applicable fee waivers. A final report is created for each seller and visible on their seller page.

Closing the event

Until an administrator closes the event, unsold fees are shown as projected. Closing freezes each seller's final figures. All item errors need to be resolved before the event can be closed.

An administrator can reopen the event only through an authorized process that records the reason.

Reports

The admin financial report shows, per seller and in total:

- Gross sales, specifics for each fee, and net payout or negative balance where applicable.
- The seller's preferred payment method, imported from the Google Form.
- Total convention revenue from all fees combined.
- Completed consignment sales and their internal Sale IDs.
- Transaction-level information needed to investigate reconciliation discrepancies.
- Fee waivers and the administrator who authorized them.

Every report exports to CSV for spreadsheets.

Seller reports show each seller their own games and sales report.

Seller payouts

Payouts themselves happen outside the app. The app reports what is owed. A transaction or check number should be recorded inside the app for each seller payout.

If negative balances are enabled, the app records the amount owed by the seller. Collection of that amount happens outside the app and a transaction number should optionally be recorded.

Safeguards and Audit Trail

The app is built so that no item can be sold twice and every change to an item or sale records who made it and when.

Risk	Safeguard
Two registers attempt to sell the same game	The database reserves the item during checkout. Both registers receive a clear error identifying the account holding the active checkout and are told to set the item aside. An Admin can investigate and release the item if appropriate.
Same game scanned twice in one sale	The app detects the duplicate barcode and refuses to add the item a second time. The error does not change the item's status or affect the transaction.
Scanning an item that is not available	Items not checked in, already in checkout, sold, missing, deactivated, or otherwise unavailable are refused at the register with a clear message. A rejected scan does not change the item's existing status or the transaction.
Last year's information sheet scanned this year	Item codes include the year, and the app rejects codes from other years.

Wrong price charged at a window change	The active price window is controlled by an administrator. The app displays the current price and total before the Sale ID is created.
Sale outside an active price window	Checkout is blocked unless an authorized administrator activates a window or uses an override.
Sale canceled before payment is received	All items associated with the transaction, including removed items, become Available again unless the item was associated with an error code like Sold or Missing.
Completed sale needs reversing	Completed sales are permanently locked. No edits, removals, reversals, or refunds are allowed.
Volunteer abandons a checkout	Before Proceed to Payment, volunteers can remove individual items or cancel the sale. After Proceed to Payment, only Cancel Sale and Payment Received are available. The action is logged.
Seller sees another seller's data	Sellers see only their own items and reports. Access is checked on the server for every page.
Duplicate Google Form submission	The app tracks imported form responses and flags repeat submissions for review rather than creating duplicate accounts.
Account security	Passwords are stored hashed, the site runs over HTTPS only, repeated failed logins are slowed down, and new users must change their temporary password on first login.

History is permanent. Records are not physically deleted. Deactivated listings remain available in the seller's Deactivated Items section and in administrative history. Every item status change

is recorded with the person and time. Admin and volunteer actions are logged, including account changes, imports, price-window changes, overrides, checkout removals and cancellations, completed sales, administrative item releases, and event closing or reopening.

Hosting and Yearly Cost

We recommend a managed host at about $175 a year, including the domain. That avoids depending on a volunteer to maintain a server.

Option	Approx. yearly cost	Who maintains it	Notes
Render (recommended)	~ $160 hosting + ~ 15 domain	Render handles the server, security patches, and database backups	Updates deploy automatically from our code repository. HTTPS included.
Small virtual server (Hetzner or DigitalOcean)	~ $60–80 hosting + 15 domain	A volunteer must apply updates and check backups	Cheaper, but riskier if that volunteer moves on.

Figures are approximate and should be checked before signing up. The app is not tied to either host and can move later. Usage outside convention weekend is tiny, so cheaper off-season tiers may lower the cost further.

Build Plan

The app is built in five phases. Each one ends with working screens the board can try, plus automated tests. No dates are set yet.

1. **Accounts and events:** Sign-in, user management, event-specific seller accounts, Google Forms connection for seller submissions, duplicate response detection, CSV import backup, and event setup, including event dates, configurable price windows, fee structures, and fee options.

2. **Seller listings and information sheets:** Sellers enter games, manage active and deactivated listings, reactivate deactivated listings, and print information sheets with a unique barcode and price table, two or six per page.
3. **Check-in and inventory:** Check-in by scanning valid sales slips, error handling, missing-item flags, item status tracking, and marking returns at pickup. No adding unlisted games at check-in.
4. **Point of sale:** Volunteer login, one open sale per register, barcode scanning, item reservations, running totals, Remove and Cancel Sale actions while adding items, Sale Summary, Proceed to Payment, Sale ID creation, locked payment stage with only Cancel Sale or Payment Received, manual payment confirmation, inventory release rules, and audit history.
5. **Reports and closing:** Seller reports, admin financial report, fee and payout calculations, CSV exports, Square CSV reconciliation, closing the event, demo data, and a how-to guide for each role.

The tests focus on what matters most: sellers cannot see each other's data, no double sales, correct prices at window boundaries, correct fee and payout calculations for both Listing Fee structures and event options, checkout reservation behavior, scan errors that do not change inventory, cancellation and payment completion behavior, deactivated listing reactivation and sales-slip validity, and permanent locking of completed sales.

Decisions Needed

The following items still need approval or further investigation:

- **Hosting budget:** Approve about $175 a year for Render plus a domain, and choose the domain name.

Appendix: technology (for future volunteer developers)

The stack uses mainstream, free tools so a future volunteer can maintain it without special skills.

Part	Choice	Why
Framework	Python 3.12 + Django 5.2 LTS	Built-in sign-in, password hashing, permissions and admin screens. Security updates until 2028. Widely known.

Database	PostgreSQL 16	Row locking prevents double sales across registers.
Screens	Django templates + HTMX, one CSS file	No JavaScript build step. The cart updates without page reloads.
Codes	QR + Code 128 barcodes drawn as SVG	Stays sharp and scannable on home printers, even slightly off-scale.
Scanning	Existing hand scanners (keyboard input), with laptop webcam and typing as backups	Works with the 1-D/2-D scanners we already own.
Tests	pytest with simulated clocks	Price windows are tested to the second.

Code layout. Shared parts (accounts, events, audit log) are kept separate from the consignment store. That way future convention modules can be added as new sections without touching the store.

Main records. Users (any mix of admin, volunteer and seller roles, plus seller number and payment method). Events (dates, windows and fees for that year). Items (three prices, status, check-in time). Item status history. Sales and sale lines (window and price frozen at checkout). Per-seller settlements frozen when the event closes. An admin action log.